WAVERLEY GATEWAY GUIDE

Connecting International Capital with Emerging & Frontier Markets

ARGENTINA

Americas

Information current as of October 2026

Dialogue | Trust | Partnership

office@lordwaverley.com
www.lordwaverley.com

WHERE AND HOW TO ENTER

KEY INVESTMENT LOCATIONS

Location / Region	Strategic Importance	Priority Sectors
Buenos Aires (City and metropolitan area)	Federal capital and commercial and financial centre; seat of government, the central bank and most corporate headquarters	Financial services, technology, professional services, consumer markets
Neuquén / Vaca Muerta shale (Patagonia)	Engine of record national oil output of 904,000 barrels a day in May 2026, with Vaca Muerta supplying 69%; host to most RIGI-approved upstream projects	Oil and gas, oilfield services, midstream infrastructure
Río Negro Atlantic coast (Punta Colorada / Golfo San Matías)	Terminus of the Vaca Muerta Oil Sur (VMOS) export pipeline, due for completion by end-2026, and site of the Southern Energy floating LNG project	Energy export logistics, LNG, port infrastructure
Salta, Jujuy and Catamarca (Lithium Triangle)	Core of the world's fourth-largest lithium supply, including Rio Tinto's $2.5 billion Rincón project in Salta targeting first production in 2028	Lithium mining and processing, engineering services
San Juan (Andean copper belt)	Host to major copper developments such as Vicuña (BHP and Lundin Mining), which has applied for RIGI benefits, with Los Azules also advancing	Copper and gold mining, mining services, power
Rosario / Santa Fe and the Pampas	Heart of the agro-export economy; soybeans, soybean oil and grains remain among Argentina's leading exports	Agribusiness, food processing, biofuels, river port logistics
Córdoba	Major industrial and agricultural province and a long-standing automotive and engineering cluster	Automotive, machinery, agro-industry, software

INVESTOR ENTRY ROUTES

- PromArgentina (Argentine Agency for the Promotion of Investments and International Trade) supports foreign investors with market intelligence and connections to opportunities across regions and sectors, working alongside Argentina's embassy network
- Incentive Regime for Large Investments (RIGI), created under the 2024 Ley Bases, offering long-term tax, customs and foreign-exchange benefits for qualifying large projects; $56 billion of projects approved as of 1 October 2026, with a further ~$150 billion under evaluation

- Flexible exchange-rate band since April 2025, with most currency controls lifted; companies may remit dividends through the official FX market for fiscal years starting on or after 1 January 2025, while legacy dividends and pre-December 2023 debts are channelled through BOPREAL central bank bonds
- Provincial authorities as the gateway to hydrocarbon and mining concessions, often in partnership with YPF for oil and gas or with established operators in copper and lithium
- United States–Argentina Agreement on Reciprocal Trade and Investment, signed 5 February 2026, lowering barriers in areas including motor vehicles and agricultural goods
- EU–Mercosur Partnership Agreement, provisionally applied from 1 May 2026, opening preferential access between Argentina and the EU market

MARKET-ENTRY OBSERVATION

Argentina in October 2026 is one of the most significant reform stories in the emerging world. Fiscal discipline has been firmly established, with a primary surplus of 1.4% of GDP and an overall surplus of 0.2% in 2025, the second consecutive year in surplus. Energy and mining are transforming the external accounts: oil output reached a record 904,000 barrels a day in May 2026, crude overtook corn and soy to become the top export, and the trade surplus approached a record $14 billion in the first half of 2026. The RIGI regime has approved $56 billion of large projects with around $150 billion more under review, Congress passed a landmark labour modernisation law in February 2026, and markets have responded: Fitch and S&P upgraded the sovereign to B- in May and June 2026, and country risk fell to an eight-year low of 421 points in July. GDP was 2% higher year-on-year in Q2 2026, although activity eased 0.6% on the quarter, with the IMF now forecasting 2.1% growth for 2026.

Argentina's main structural challenge is completing its macroeconomic normalisation after decades of high inflation and currency controls. Annual inflation stood at 33.4% in September 2026, but monthly core inflation has eased to 1.7% and the trend has broadly slowed since April. The central bank has bought $14.7 billion of foreign exchange so far in 2026, gross reserves stand at about $48.7 billion and net reserves have risen by more than $20 billion on a cash basis since December 2023, supported by a $20 billion IMF programme of which around $15.8 billion has been disbursed. Recorded foreign direct investment was a modest $3.1 billion in 2025, partly reflecting one-off debt cancellations, and some corporate FX restrictions remain. These are precisely the areas in which progress is now visible: energy companies resumed dividend remittances in 2026 for the first time since 2019, and the government reports that 2026–27 foreign-currency debt maturities are already funded. For investors, the opportunity is to establish positions ahead of further normalisation, with RIGI providing long-term protection for large projects.

INVESTOR RISK & MARKET ACCESS

KEY ENTRY BARRIERS

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Inflation still above regional norms	Annual inflation was 33.4% in September 2026 and the central bank survey expects around 30% by end-2026, although monthly core inflation has eased to 1.7%	Index local contracts and pricing, use inflation-linked (UVA) instruments where relevant, and plan for continued gradual disinflation
Remaining corporate FX restrictions	Dividends are remittable for fiscal years from 2025, but legacy dividends, pre-December 2023 intercompany debts and some related-party payments remain subject to rules and waiting periods	Structure new investment to benefit from current rules or RIGI FX protections, and use BOPREAL for legacy positions with local counsel
Softer domestic activity in 2026	GDP eased 0.6% quarter-on-quarter in Q2 2026 as a stronger peso and import competition weighed on manufacturing, retail and construction, while exports grew	Prioritise export-oriented sectors such as energy, mining and agribusiness, which are setting records and earn hard currency
Reserve levels and the IMF programme	Gross reserves of about $48.7 billion are rebuilding steadily, and the third review of the $20 billion IMF programme is under discussion after an earlier target waiver	Track review outcomes and central bank FX purchases, which reached $14.7 billion in 2026 to early October, as indicators of strengthening buffers
Sovereign credit standing	Ratings remain sub-investment grade at B- (Fitch, S&P), although country risk reached an eight-year low of 421 points in July 2026	Use multilateral co-financing (IFC, World Bank, IDB) and political-risk cover for large projects, with upside as ratings improve

Issue	Potential Impact	Possible Mitigation
Policy continuity and the political cycle	Reforms have broad momentum after La Libertad Avanza won 40.8% in the 2025 midterms, with the next presidential election due in 2027	RIGI's long-term stability guarantees help protect large projects; maintain engagement with both national and provincial authorities
Energy infrastructure bottlenecks	Export and winter gas capacity are still catching up with production, with winter gas demand above 180 million m^3 a day against output of about 140 million	VMOS completion and new LNG capacity from late 2027 create opportunities in pipelines, storage, ports and gas processing

INVESTOR RISK NOTE

Argentina's risk profile is improving rapidly from a historically challenging base. Two consecutive years of fiscal surplus, steady reserve accumulation, rating upgrades to B- and an eight-year low in country risk show that the stabilisation programme is gaining credibility, while record energy production and trade surpluses are building a durable hard-currency base. Investors should still plan for inflation that, while falling, remains well above regional levels, for residual corporate FX rules on legacy positions, and for the policy sensitivity of the 2027 electoral cycle. These risks are manageable through inflation-indexed contracting, careful structuring with local counsel, multilateral co-financing and use of the RIGI framework, which offers long-term tax, customs and FX stability for qualifying projects. For investors willing to engage early, Argentina offers exposure to one of the world's leading shale basins, a major lithium and copper pipeline and a deep agribusiness sector at a point of improving fundamentals.

MARKET ACCESS

Argentina is a founding member of Mercosur, giving preferential access to Brazil, Paraguay and Uruguay, and a WTO member. Its trade reach is widening: the EU–Mercosur Partnership Agreement has applied provisionally since 1 May 2026, and the Agreement on Reciprocal Trade and Investment with the United States was signed in February 2026. In 2025 exports reached $87.1 billion, led by Brazil (14.7%), China (11.3%), the EU (9.7%) and the United States (9.6%), with large bilateral surpluses with Chile, India and Peru. Agricultural exports flow through the Paraná river ports around Rosario, while new Atlantic export capacity for oil and LNG is being built on the Río Negro coast, adding energy to Argentina's established role as a global food supplier.

WHO SHOULD THE INVESTOR MEET?

INSTITUTIONAL LANDSCAPE

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Office of the President (Javier Milei)	Drives the stabilisation, deregulation and pro-investment reform agenda, strengthened by the 2025 midterm result	Primary reference point for Argentina's strategic and reform direction
Ministry of Economy (Luis Caputo)	Leads fiscal policy, IMF relations and the RIGI approval process	Key counterpart for large-project approvals and macroeconomic policy insight
PromArgentina	National investment and trade promotion agency, connecting international investors with opportunities across regions and sectors	Standard first point of contact for market entry and sector guidance
Banco Central de la República Argentina (Santiago Bausili)	Monetary authority; manages the exchange-rate band, FX regulations, reserve accumulation and BOPREAL	Essential for understanding FX access, dividend remittance and the pace of liberalisation
YPF (majority state-owned energy company)	Leading Vaca Muerta operator and partner in the Southern Energy LNG export project	Central partner for oil, gas and LNG engagement
Ministry of Foreign Affairs (Pablo Quirno)	Negotiated the US trade and investment agreement and supports investment promotion through the embassy network	Relevant for trade-agreement access and government-to-government engagement
Provincial governments (Neuquén, Río	Own subsoil resources and grant	Essential partners for any energy or mining

Actor	Why It Matters	Waverley Engagement Angle
Negro, Salta, San Juan, Catamarca)	hydrocarbon and mining concessions and local permits	investment

CURRENT INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS CHANNELS

The American Chamber of Commerce in Argentina and the British–Argentine Chamber of Commerce are the leading international business associations, and the EU Delegation hosted an EU Investment and Business Forum in Argentina in 2026. PromArgentina and Argentine embassies organise investment seminars, business visits and sector briefings, and major provinces run their own investment promotion offices. Mining and energy events, notably in San Juan and Neuquén, bring together operators, suppliers and officials. The World Bank, IFC, Inter-American Development Bank and CAF are active in infrastructure, energy and private-sector finance, with IFC and the World Bank in financing discussions on major lithium development.

INVESTOR PROFILE BEST SUITED

Argentina best suits investors with a medium- to long-term horizon who can benefit from an economy in active normalisation: energy investors in Vaca Muerta upstream, midstream and LNG; mining companies and suppliers targeting lithium and copper, where the government projects combined exports of $32.7 billion within ten years; agribusiness and food-processing investors building on a world-class export base; and infrastructure, logistics and power investors serving these sectors. Large-ticket projects benefit most from RIGI's stability guarantees, while technology and services investors can draw on a skilled workforce in Buenos Aires and Córdoba. Consumer-facing investors should calibrate entry to the pace of disinflation and domestic recovery.

FROM INTELLIGENCE TO ENGAGEMENT

STEP 1: Engage PromArgentina and the Ministry of Economy
Open dialogue on sector opportunities and assess whether the project qualifies for RIGI's long-term tax, customs and FX benefits.

STEP 2: Structure FX and repatriation with local counsel
Design capital, dividend and intercompany flows around the current central bank rules, using RIGI protections or BOPREAL where relevant.

STEP 3: Build relationships with provincial authorities
Engage provincial governments early on concessions, permits and community matters, since provinces own subsoil resources.

STEP 4: Partner with established operators and multilaterals
Consider joint ventures with YPF or experienced mining operators, and co-financing or risk cover from IFC, the World Bank or IDB.

STEP 5: Track macroeconomic normalisation milestones
Monitor inflation, reserve accumulation, IMF reviews and further FX liberalisation to time expansion into domestic-facing sectors.